

All about me

- BORN: 1805
- DIED: 1881
- NATIONALITY: Jamaican
- FACTOID: I was awarded medals by Britain, France, and Turkey.
- IN A NUTSHELL: My father was a Scottish soldier and my mother was black, which made me mixed race.

*By the way...
when I returned to
England, I was penniless
and sick, so a benefit
festival was organized
to raise money for me.*

Mary Seacole

A pioneering NURSE who, like Florence Nightingale, cared for soldiers in the Crimean War, but got less recognition

The determined nurse

Mary **learned medicine** from her mother, who cared for wounded soldiers. In 1853, when she heard about a **shortage of nurses** in the Crimean War, she went to London to volunteer. She was turned down—possibly because of her race—but Mary was certain that she could help, so she traveled to **CRIMEA** (in eastern Europe) anyway.



Mother Seacole

With no money, **she built a hospital** with salvaged driftwood, old packing cases, and sheets of iron, which became a **home for sick soldiers**. During the fighting, she even visited battlefields to nurse the wounded. Her immense **BRAVERY** and nursing skills made her as famous as Nightingale, who looked down on Mary's low social status and mixed-race background. Her patients called her Mother Seacole.